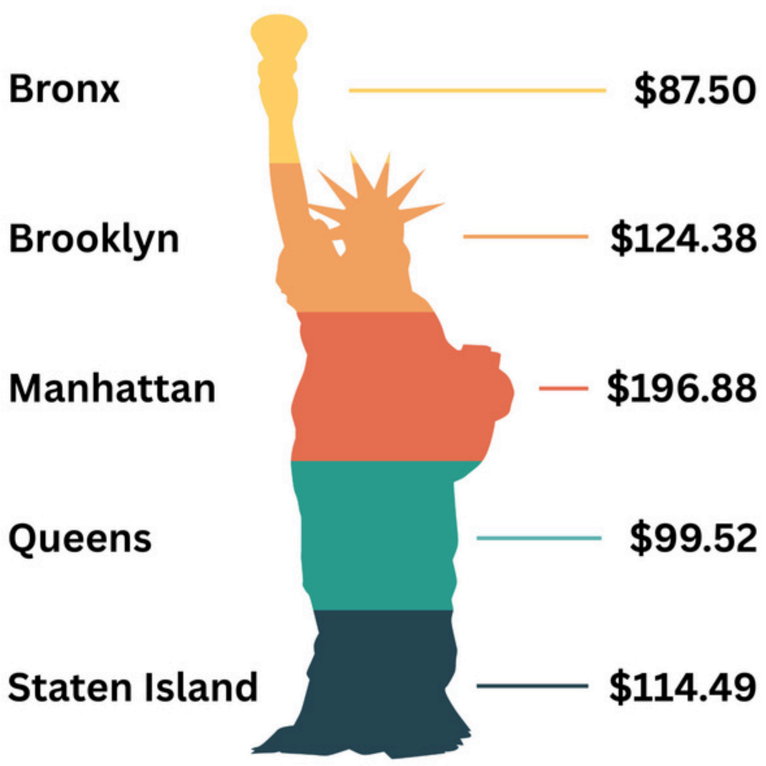
NEW YORK AIRBNBS



The Statue of Libery chart is divided into five bands, one per borough, but the bands have equal height and non-proportional area. Additionally, the chart does not label any axises or what the prices are of. The only variable disinguishing the bands are the colors. Overall, this visualization provides practically no information and no real context.

This raincloud plot has one panel per borough also separated by room type. Each row is a raincloud with the rain (raw, granular data), the box (a boxplot), and the cloud (a half-violin plot).

These two visualizations use the same dataset of NYC Airbnb prices to demonstrate how data visualization is a modeling choice. The raincloud plot gives a lot more information as it combines raw data points, boxplots, and density curves to show spread and a confounding variable (room type). By separating data by room type, the raincloud plot reveals that Manhattan's price premium is actually driven by having mroe entire-home listings rather than location alone. The Statue of Liberty's silhouette, in contrast, distorts the same data by representing each borough's mean price with an equal sized band. Using the mean price instead of another value skews the numbers towards extreme outliers. Together, the visualizations show how being mislead can stem from a designer's choice, rather than bad data.

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